

Teacher card

Comparing festivals of light / GROW_RE_A1_W06

Outcome: Compare two festivals of light respectfully using one similarity and one difference.

Evidence to retain: F: comparison with one similarity and one difference.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Model comparison of ideas, not ranking religions; use 'some/many'; adult checks one accurate fact for each festival before comparison.

Access and regulation

Compare only two festivals; colour-coded prompts; 'poth/however' frame; oral-first response; scribe/typing; reduced writing target.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

This is learning about religion and worldviews, not worship. Nobody is asked to share a personal belief, family detail or loss.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner's individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner's evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: Give one similarity between two festivals of light.

Evidence: A Diwali: Many Hindus, Sikhs and Jains. Diyas and rangoli. For many Hindus the light recalls Rama and Sita and good overcoming evil. B Hanukkah: Jewish. Eight nights. The menorah recalls the rededication of the Temple and the oil that lasted.

Think aloud: Both use light as a symbol, or both bring people together.

Check: Do we compare festivals to decide which is best? No. We compare to understand.

Arrival answers

1. The incarnation: God became human in Jesus.
2. To look for what is the same and what is different
3. Both use light as a symbol, or both bring people together.
4. No. We compare to understand.

Shared activity reasoning

1. Light is used as a symbol — Similarity. All three cards mention light.
2. The story behind the light — Difference. Each festival recalls a different story.
3. Families and communities gather — Similarity. All three bring people together.

Exit responses

Give one similarity between two festivals of light. Both use light as a symbol, or both bring people together.

Do we compare festivals to decide which is best? No. We compare to understand.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Arrival: 4 retrieval questions from Diwali, Hanukkah and Christmas. Starter: identify each festival from an image. I Do: model a respectful comparison using 'poth / however'. We Do: sort similarities and differences in symbols, stories and meanings. You Do: compare two festivals using a scaffold. Exit ticket: one similarity or difference.

Look for

F: comparison with one similarity and one difference.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

Hindu American Foundation Diwali <https://www.hinduamerican.org/diwali>

Chabad What is Hanukkah https://www.chabad.org/holidays/chanukah/article_cdo/aid/102911/jewish/What-Is-Hanukkah.htm

Sikh Coalition introduction to Sikh beliefs and practice
<https://www.sikhcoalition.org/about-sikhs/>

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.